

The Separated Denominational Churches.

The Apostles in the First Century Started House Churches

House Churches are the only churches in the New Testament. Starting in the second century, cathedrals were built on top of the first house churches long after the first generation of the Church and the apostles had died.

Christians around the world believe in Jesus Christ's divinity, the Trinity of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, and the authority of the scriptures as the Word of God. However, despite these shared beliefs, an immense number of Christians have separated into various denominations. The differences between these denominations can range from their worship styles to their interpretations of theological teachings.

Roman Catholic Church

In 607 AD, Pope Boniface III received a decree from the Byzantine Emperor Phocas declaring the Roman See (the Diocese of Rome) as the "head of all the Churches" and the Pope as the "Universal Bishop." This decree solidified the Pope's primacy over other bishops and marked a crucial step in the establishment of papal supremacy. Its headquarters are located in Vatican City. Today, around 18.7% of the U.S. population, totaling around 62 million people, identifies as Roman Catholics, illustrating the enduring influence of this denomination.

1260 years later, in 1867, the Papal States, which were territories in central Italy governed by the Pope, faced significant challenges due to the ongoing process of Italian unification. Forces aligned with the Italian nationalist movement sought to unify the various Italian states, including the Papal States, into a single nation-state.

During this time, conflicts and military actions involving the Papal States occurred. In 1860, some territories were annexed by the Kingdom of Sardinia. By 1870, with the capture of Rome, the process of Italian unification was completed. **As a result, the Papal States ceased to exist, and Rome became the capital of the newly unified Kingdom of Italy.**

During the Dark Ages, the Papacy conducted an Inquisition, which gave the state authority to kill the saints. During this time, no one in Europe could buy, sell, or conduct business without approval and license from the Roman Catholic Church.

Eastern Orthodox Church

The first division in Christianity occurred in the Great Schism of 1054 when the Eastern Orthodox Church separated from the Roman Catholic Church. **The Eastern Orthodox Church contested the authority of the Pope** and emphasized a collective consensus of Bishops. Other differences included the use of leavened bread and Greek text in the Eastern Orthodox Church. There are between 1 and 6 million members of the Eastern Orthodox Church in America.

Church of England

Formed in 16th-century England, the Church of England was the first major Protestant denomination of Christianity. It was associated with the reign of King Henry VIII, which prompted many individuals across Europe to break away from the Roman Catholic Church.

Puritanism

Upon the formation of the Church of England, the Puritanism movement emerged in the late 16th century. The Puritans sought a simpler form of worship, emphasized personal holiness, and stressed the need to lead a devout life through simple living, frugality, and hard work. Their influence on the American colonies through immigration was significant, and their impact can still be observed in the cultural and social landscape of America today.

Lutheranism

The first Protestant denomination to break away from Catholicism was Lutheranism, which was a Reformation movement in Germany in the 16th century. This division was caused by the excessive practices of the Roman Catholic Church at that time. The German monk Martin Luther believed that these practices contradicted true Christianity. Today, there are 3.3 million members of the Evangelical Lutheran Church in America.

Presbyterianism

Drawing inspiration from the 16th-century Protestant Reformation, Presbyterianism was established based on the doctrines of John Knox and John Calvin. It entails a system of elected elders in the Church. It emphasizes simple worship, with followers concentrating on missionary work and addressing social injustice. Today, there are over 1 million Presbyterians in America.

Baptist

Baptists originated in England during the 17th century and were influenced by the Puritanism movement. The Southern Baptist Convention is a significant denomination in the United States. This denomination advocates for the complete immersion of an individual during baptism as a way to cleanse all sin. There are 50 million Baptists in America, constituting 15.3% of the

country's population and a third of all American Protestants.

Methodism

Founded in 18th-century England by John Wesley, Methodism positioned itself as a "renewal movement" aligned with Anglicanism. The United Methodist Church is a significant denomination in America. Wesley inspired working-class individuals who were often overlooked by other

churches and emphasized salvation through faith in Jesus Christ. Presently, there are 6.5 million Methodists in America.

Mormonism

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, also known as Mormonism, is a 19th-century Christian denomination founded by Joseph Smith. This group views the Book of Mormon as having equal importance to the Bible. Currently, there are approximately 6.5 million Mormons in America.

Episcopal Church

The Episcopal Church in America, considered an American branch of the Church of England, has a current membership of around 1.5 million. This denomination has some practices in common with the Anglican Church. It maintains the Nicene Creed as a statement of faith, as also used in the Church of England and the Roman Catholic Church.

Seventh-Day Adventist

The Seventh-day Adventist denomination, founded in the 19th century, observes the Sabbath on Saturdays in accordance with the Fourth Commandment, which is a significant departure from the Sunday observance of other Christian denominations. This denomination also promotes vegetarianism and abstains from alcohol and tobacco, reflecting a unique set of beliefs and practices that may pique the interest of the audience. Today, over 1 million Seventh-day Adventists in America adhere to these distinctive principles.

Jehovah's Witness

The Jehovah's Witness denomination in America has about 2.5 million members and is growing every day. Founded in the late 19th century, followers of Jehovah's Witness believe that Jesus Christ is the highest creation of God and that we are currently living in the final days.

Church of the Nazarene

The Church of the Nazarene is a relatively small Christian denomination in America, with around 650,000 members. Established in the late 19th century, it is dedicated to propagating

the Gospel and striving for holiness.

Pentecostalism

Christianity's Pentecostal denomination was created in the early 20th century and has amassed a staggering 65 million followers across America. This denomination focuses on experiencing the Holy Spirit with many followers "speaking in tongues" and witnessing practices of divine healing.

Assemblies of God

The Assemblies of God denomination has more than 13,000 churches and 3 million members in America. It was founded in 1914 and is influenced by Pentecostal Christianity, making it a relatively new denomination.

Quakers

The Religious Society of Friends, also known as Quakers, is a Christian denomination that advocates simplicity, pacifism, and silent worship. Quakers uphold strong moral values, reject materialism, and promote equality for all individuals. Quaker women have played a significant role in the movement since its inception, and all Quakers have been outspoken opponents of slavery and the mistreatment of Native Americans. Presently, there are approximately 75,000 Quakers in America.

Christian Science Church

The Christian Science Church was established in the late 19th century. It promotes the belief that sickness, death, and sin are illusions that can be overcome through spiritual empowerment. The Church offers spiritual treatments for those seeking healing. Currently, there are approximately 300,000 members of the Christian Science Church in America.

First Century House Churches

The First-Century House Church was Patterned After Synagogues

Ancient Synagogues

Ancient synagogues were small compared with modern cathedrals and churches. Only those living within a “Sabbath day's journey” (2000 feet) attended. Everyone sat in a square. *Everyone who attended the synagogue was expected to be involved.*

Every male 12 & older was expected to read the scriptures. It was part of his religious training. He was given this opportunity to read a scripture he didn't understand and get the help of the elderly men in the synagogue. As the next person in line, the young man would stand in the center of the synagogue and read so that everyone could see and hear him. It was the scriptures, not the one reading them, that was exalted. In this way, each male over the age of 12 equally took turns reading a short portion from the holy scriptures and then sat down. After the scriptures were read, every man who desired to do so took turns responding to what was read. After everyone was finished speaking and responding in an orderly fashion, the next person in line to read would stand in the middle, read a short portion of scripture, sit down, and so forth.

The First Century House Church

While the apostles were still alive, **the church was the people who believed in Jesus Christ and met for worship in the home** of one of the believers.

Everyone sat in a square or circle. The one next to read stood in the center so everyone in the house could see and hear what was being read. The most prized writings were the four gospels, the letters of Paul or one of the other eyewitnesses of Jesus Christ after the resurrection—the Apostles.

Do you want to understand the Scriptures?

Each male over the age of 12 took turns reading a short portion of the scriptures. He read something that he wanted help to understand and then sat down. Then, all the older Christians took turns in an orderly fashion, from youngest to oldest, responding to what was read. After everyone had finished speaking and edifying one another, the next person read from the scriptures something that he wanted help to understand and then sat down, and so forth.

The Early Christian Church

A young man has just finished reading a few verses from the scriptures (usually less than 2 minutes' worth of reading), and sits down. Everyone is sitting in a circle or a square; There are only a couple dozen people in the home. Everyone, in an orderly fashion, from youngest to oldest, took turns sharing what the Holy Ghost had put in their hearts concerning what they heard while the scriptures were being read. There was an elder present who would speak up if an error was made. These first-century house meetings were intensely interesting. No one knew what topics or what scriptures would be discussed in advance. Everyone was given a chance to read the scriptures, and they needed help understanding and had an opportunity to practice answering to defend their faith—every week. The house church trained everyone on how to be Christians and defend the faith.

After Reading the Scriptures, There Is A “Love Feast”

After everyone had their fill of scriptures and edified each other, the women presented to the whole church a love feast filled with all manner of delicious food. While the bread is being passed around and eaten, everyone remembers the broken body of Jesus Christ on the Cross. While the fruit of the vine is being passed around the room for everyone to drink from, the church remembers the blood of Jesus that was sprinkled around the Cross for 6 hours for their sins.

How the Early Church Used the Money That Was Collected

By the time church ends everyone has had a chance to talk to one another and is intimately acquainted with each other's lives. Is all caught up on what happened during the week. Help is offered to any of the poor who need it, and no one goes away wanting anything.

The collections were made for the poor, the widows and the fatherless, and anyone else that had a desperate need. No one had to worry about their daily needs.

Love Your Neighbor

Go two thousand feet in every direction from your home, which is about 4 city blocks. Knock on every neighbor's door, and find as many Christians as you can. Then invite them to your home! Ask each family to bring their bibles and a dish of food to share with everyone after the Bible reading & open discussion. Go from house to house giving each family an opportunity to host the home church in their own homes each week, and take up collections to help the poor and needy in your community.

Ye Are Taught of God to Love One Another.

Next, imagine the unbelievers in town and how they would sit up and take notice. The Christians in town help each other, meet in each other's homes, and love each other. The Christians help the poor, no one that has any need among them is neglected. Christians eat together and are more like a family, than in modern churches.

Invite Your Neighbors to Your Home

Finally imagine how easy it is, to invite unbelievers to visit your home for a meal. Invite them to

observe a Bible reading, and enjoy a feast afterward. Who among the thousands of lonely people in your town could turn an offer like that down?

Are there too many for one house church? That is okay! It's time to grow into a community of house churches! Trust each house church to God, that the Holy Spirit will lead each one of them. Where two or three are gathered in Jesus's name, Jesus is there!

What Do You Need to Get Started?

All you need to start a home church is the Holy Bible. If you have a Bible you have everything you need. Invite other Christians and take turns going from house to house. Each able family should bring delicious food to share with everyone afterward. Make sure there is bread and grape juice! Make the time to share the bread and grape juice special. Take up a collection to be used for the poor in your community and also for missionary outreach in your area.

How To Discover Truth?

1. Set aside all preconceived ideas. Opinions don't matter! The Holy Bible is the only source of truth!

2. Find 100% of the verses in the Holy Bible on each topic discussed. Don't leave a single verse out!

3. Believe whatever the Bible says. Conclusions must always line up with 100% of the Bible's verses discovered during Step #2

A Helpful Example: There are approximately 60 verses in the Bible that discuss what happens at death. 95% of these verses teach the same thing so clearly that a child can see it and understand it. Then, on the opposite side, there are 1-2 verses that appear to teach something different. So, what is the truth? Obviously, we ought to take our stand with the weightier 95% of these verses and what they teach us. The 5% or 1-2 verses that appear to teach something different need to be studied more carefully. In the end, it is always demonstrated that there is 100% unity in the scriptures. Preconceived ideas from what we have been taught over a lifetime might have been preventing us from seeing it.

Most of the major topics in the Bible have 30-40 verses that mention them.

1. **Step 1.** Set aside all preconceived ideas. Opinions don't matter! The Holy Bible is the only source of truth!

2. **Step 2.** Find 100% of the 30-40 verses that speak about the topic being discussed.

3. **Step 3.** Then, determine what 95% of these verses clearly teach and believe whatever those verses teach. After you study the other 5% of these verses more closely, you will always discover 100% unity in the scriptures on every topic.

How Heresy Occurs.

There will always be someone who stubbornly holds on to the "5% or 1-2 verses" and ignores

the “95% or 35+ verses” and will not be convinced no matter how many bible texts you show them. That is one way that heresies come into the church.

Hero Worship

Another way heresies enter the church is through “hero worship.” A famous church father or person from Church History writes or says something, and no matter how many verses you show them from the Holy Bible, they won't go against their favorite church hero. Do not be deceived by them. This type of person is NOT “a Bible-alone Christian.”

Romans 16:17 ¶ Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offenses contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.

Do not argue or debate with a heretic; rather, reject them from your home!

Titus 3:10. A man that is an heretick after the first and second admonition reject;

House Churches the Only Churches in the Bible

The Apostles Started House Churches; they were not the Builders of Grand Cathedrals.

Acts 2:46-47 And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread **from house to house**, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart, Praising God, and having favour with all the people. And **the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.**

Acts 8:3 As for Saul, he made havock of **the church, entering into every house**, and haling men and women committed *them* to prison.

Romans 16:5 Likewise *greet* **the church that is in their house**. Salute my wellbeloved Epaphroditus, who is the firstfruits of Achaia unto Christ.

1 Corinthians 16:19 ¶ The churches of Asia salute you. Aquila and Priscilla salute you much in the Lord, with **the church that is in their house**.

Colossians 4:15 Salute the brethren which are in Laodicea, and Nymphas, and **the church which is in his house**.

1 Timothy 3:5 (For if a man know not how to rule **his own house**, how shall he take care of **the church of God**?)

1 Timothy 3:15 But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in **the house of God**, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.

Philemon 2 And to *our* beloved Apphia, and Archippus our fellowsoldier, and **to the church in thy house**:

Houses that Followed Peter Were Not Set Above Other Houses

1 Corinthians 1:11-13 For it hath been declared unto me of you, my brethren, by them *which are of the house* of Chloe, that there are contentions among you. Now this I say, that **every one of you saith, I am of Paul; and I of Apollos; and I of Cephas; and I of Christ. Is Christ divided?** was Paul crucified for you? or were ye baptized in the name of Paul?

1 Corinthians 2:2 For I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ, and him crucified.

1 Corinthians 3:3-6 For ye are yet carnal: for whereas *there is* among you envying, and strife, and divisions, are ye not carnal, and walk as men? **For while one saith, I am of Paul; and another, I am of Apollos; are ye not carnal?** ¶ Who then is Paul, and who *is* Apollos, but ministers by whom ye believed, even as the Lord gave to every man? I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.

1 Corinthians 3:9 For **we are labourers** together with God: **ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.**

1 Corinthians 3:22 Whether Paul, or Apollos, or Cephas, or the world, or life, or death, or things present, or things to come; **all are yours;**

1 Corinthians 4:6 And these things, brethren, I have in a figure transferred to myself and to Apollos for your sakes; that ye might **learn in us not to think of men above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another.**

How to start a “House Church” or Home Bible Study Group

All that is needed is your Bibles. A pastor and a sermon is not necessary! You can study topically or work your way through a book of the Bible, one verse at a time.

1. Start by inviting people you see regularly to “join some friends and our families for a

Bible study. There will be a meal afterward.”

2. Start with prayer requests, write them down, and update the list each week.
3. Read and study the Bible. Every male over the age of 12, take turns reading a verse or two. Allow the young men to choose something they want help understanding. In an orderly fashion, starting with the young men, working your way up to the elderly, find related verses that can help explain and discuss what was read.
4. Gather a collection / financial offerings to help anyone in need, especially those of your own house church.
5. Remember the body and blood of Christ, examine yourselves, wait for each other to be ready, then enjoy a meal together,

“Not for that we have dominion over your faith” 2 Corinthians 1:24

“For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.” Matthew 18:20

Q. Which Church Do You Go To?

- “I go to the church at the house of My family and I are followers of Christ. We are called Christians.”

“All Ye Are Brethren”

But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, *even* Christ; and **all ye are brethren**. And call no *man* your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven. Neither be ye called masters: for one is your Master, *even* Christ. **Matthew 23:8-10**

Evangelists, Bishops, Elders & Deacons

Evangelists

Acts 6:1-7 ¶ And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration. **Then the twelve called the multitude of the disciples *unto them*, and said, It is not reason that we should leave the word of God, and serve tables.** Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business. But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word. And the saying pleased the whole multitude: and **they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip, and Prochorus, and Nicanor, and Timon, and Parmenas, and Nicolas a proselyte of Antioch:** Whom they set before the apostles: and when they had prayed, they laid *their* hands on them. And **the word of God increased; and the number of the disciples multiplied in Jerusalem greatly; and a great company of the priests were obedient to the faith.**

Acts 21:8 ¶ And the next *day* we that were of Paul's company departed, and came unto Caesarea: and we entered into the house of **Philip the evangelist, which was *one* of the seven; and abode with him.**

Ephesians 4:11 And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, **evangelists**; and some, pastors and teachers;

2 Timothy 4:5 But watch thou in all things, endure afflictions, **do the work of an evangelist**, make full proof of thy ministry.

Bishops

Timothy 3:1-7 ¶ This *is* a true saying, If a man desire **the office of a bishop**, he desireth a good work. **A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous; One that ruleth well his own house,**

having his children in subjection with all gravity; (For if a man know not how to rule his own house, how shall he take care of the church of God?) **Not a novice**, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil. Moreover he must have a good report of them which are without; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.

Acts 20:28 Take heed therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock, over the which **the Holy Ghost hath made you overseers, to feed the church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood.**

Philippians 1:1 ¶ Paul and Timotheus, the servants of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus which are at Philippi, **with the bishops** and deacons:

1 Timothy 3:2 A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

2 Timothy 4:22 The Lord Jesus Christ *be* with thy spirit. Grace *be* with you. Amen. The second *e* *pistle* unto **Timotheus, ordained the first bishop of the church of the Ephesians**, was written from Rome, when Paul was brought before Nero the second time.

Titus 1:7 For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Titus 3:15 All that are with me salute thee. Greet them that love us in the faith. Grace *be* with you all. Amen. It was written to **Titus, ordained the first bishop of the church of the Cretians**, from Nicopolis of Macedonia.

1 Peter 2:25 For ye were as sheep going astray; but are now returned unto **the Shepherd and Bishop of your souls.**

Elders

1 Timothy 5:1 ¶ Rebuke not **an elder**, but intreat *him* as a father; *and* the younger men as brethren;

1 Timothy 5:17 Let **the elders that rule well** be counted worthy of double honour, especially they who labour in the word and doctrine.

1 Timothy 5:19 Against **an elder** receive not an accusation, but before two or three witnesses.

Titus 1:5 For this cause left I thee in Crete, that thou shouldest set in order the things that are wanting, and **ordain elders in every city**, as I had appointed thee:

Hebrews 11:1-2 ¶ Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen. For **by it the elders obtained a good report.**

James 5:14 Is any sick among you? let him **call for the elders of the church**; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord:

1 Peter 5:1 ¶ The elders which are among you **I exhort, who am also an elder**, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and also a partaker of the glory that shall be revealed:

1 Peter 5:5 ¶ Likewise, ye younger, **submit yourselves unto the elder**. Yea, all *of you* be subject one to another, and be clothed with humility: for God resisteth the proud, and giveth grace to the humble.

2 John 1 ¶ The elder unto the elect lady and her children, whom I love in the truth; and not I only, but also all they that have known the truth;

3 John 1 ¶ The elder unto the wellbeloved Gaius, whom I love in the truth.

Deacons

Philippians 1:1 ¶ Paul and Timotheus, the servants of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus which are at Philippi, with the bishops and deacons:

1 Timothy 3:8-13 ¶ Likewise *must* the deacons *be* grave, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience. And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being *found* blamless. Even so *must their wives be* grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things. Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well. For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.

Ministers & Pastors

“All Ye Are Brethren”

But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, *even* Christ; and **all ye are brethren**. And call no *man* your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven. Neither be ye called masters: for one is your Master, *even* Christ. **Matthew 23:8-10**

2 Chronicles 15:3 Now for a long season Israel *hath been* without the true God, and without a teaching priest, and without law.

Jeremiah 3:15 And I will give you pastors according to mine heart, which shall feed you with knowledge and understanding.

Jeremiah 17:16 As for me, I have not hastened from *being* a pastor to follow thee: neither have I desired the woeful day; thou knowest: **that which came out of my lips was *right* before thee.**

Matthew 28:20 **Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you:** and, lo, I am with you *always, even* unto the end of the world. Amen.

Acts 13:1 ¶ Now there were **in the church that was at Antioch** certain prophets and teachers; as Barnabas, and Simeon that was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene, and Manaen, which had

been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, **and Saul**.

Romans 12:7 Or ministry, *let us wait on our* ministering: or he that teacheth, on teaching;

1 Corinthians 12:29 *Are* all apostles? *are* all prophets? **are all teachers?** *are* all workers of miracles?

Hebrews 5:12 For when for the time **ye ought to be teachers**, ye have need that one teach you again which *be* the first principles of the oracles of God; and are become such as have need of milk, and not of strong meat.

1 Peter 5:1-3 ¶ The elders which are among you I exhort, who am also an elder, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and also a partaker of the glory that shall be revealed: Feed the flock of God which is among you, taking the oversight *thereof*, not by constraint, but willingly; not for filthy lucre, but of a ready mind; Neither as being lords over *God's* heritage, but being ensamples to the flock.

Not Greedy of Filthy Lucre

Isaiah 56:11 Yea, **they are greedy dogs which can never have enough, and they are shepherds that cannot understand**: they all look to their own way, **every one for his gain**, from his quarter.

1 Timothy 3:3 Not given to wine, no striker, **not greedy of filthy lucre**; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

1 Timothy 3:8 ¶ Likewise *must* the deacons *be* grave, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, **not greedy of filthy lucre**;

Titus 1:7 For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, **not given to filthy lucre**;

Titus 1:11 Whose mouths must be stopped, who subvert whole houses, teaching things which they ought not, **for filthy lucre's sake**.

1 Peter 5:2 Feed the flock of God which is among you, taking the oversight *thereof*, not by constraint, but willingly; **not for filthy lucre**, but of a ready mind;

Jude 11 Woe unto them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and **ran greedily after the**

error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core.

Not Adorned with Costly Array & Jewelry

Matthew 11:7-8 ¶ And as they departed, Jesus began to say unto the multitudes concerning John, *What went ye out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken with the wind? But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? behold, they that wear soft *clothing* are in kings' houses.*

1 Timothy 2:9-10 ¶ In like manner also, **that women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with broided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array ;** But (which becometh women professing godliness) with good works.

1 Peter 3:1-6 ¶ Likewise, ye wives, *be* in subjection to your own husbands; that, if any obey not the word, they also may without the word be won by the conversation of the wives; While they behold your chaste conversation *coupled* with fear. **Whose adorning let it not be that outward *adorning* of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel;** But *let it be* the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, *even the ornament* of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price. For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves, being in subjection unto their own husbands: Even as Sara obeyed Abraham, calling him lord: whose daughters ye are, as long as ye do well, and are not afraid with any amazement.

Preach the Word—Not Philosophy & Fables

Colossians 2:8 Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the rudiments of the world, and not after Christ.

Deuteronomy 6:12 *Then* beware lest thou forget the LORD, which brought thee forth out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.

Matthew 7:15 ¶ Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravening wolves.

Matthew 10:17 But beware of men: for they will deliver you up to the councils, and they will scourge you in their synagogues;

Matthew 16:6 Then Jesus said unto them, Take heed and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.

Philippians 3:2 Beware of dogs, beware of evil workers, beware of the concision.

2 Peter 3:17 Ye therefore, beloved, seeing ye know *these things* before, beware lest ye also, being led away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own steadfastness.

Colossians 2:18 Let no man beguile you of your reward in a voluntary humility and worshipping of angels, intruding into those things which he hath not seen, vainly puffed up by his fleshly mind,

Song of Solomon 2:15 Take us the foxes, the little foxes, that spoil the vines: for our vines *have* tender grapes.

Jeremiah 29:8 ¶ For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Let not your prophets and your diviners, that *be* in the midst of you, deceive you, neither hearken to your dreams which ye cause to be dreamed.

Romans 16:17 ¶ Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.

Ephesians 5:6 Let no man deceive you with vain words: for because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.

Hebrews 13:9 Be not carried about with divers and strange doctrines. For *it is* a good thing that the heart be established with grace; not with meats, which have not profited them that have been occupied therein.

2 John 8 Look to yourselves, that we lose not those things which we have wrought, but that we receive a full reward.

Acts 17:18 Then certain philosophers of the Epicureans, and of the Stoicks, encountered him. And some said, What will this babbler say? other some, He seemeth to be a setter forth of strange gods: because he preached unto them Jesus, and the resurrection.

Acts 17:32 ¶ And when they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked: and others said, We will hear thee again of this *matter*.

Romans 1:21-22 Because that, when they knew God, they glorified *him* not as God, neither were thankful; but became vain in their imaginations, and their foolish heart was darkened. Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools,

1 Corinthians 1:19-23 For it is written, I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and will bring to nothing the understanding of the prudent. Where *is* the wise? where *is* the scribe? where *is* the disputer of this world? hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world? For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe. For the Jews require a sign, and the Greeks seek after

wisdom: But we preach Christ crucified, unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness;

1 Corinthians 3:18-19 ¶ Let no man deceive himself. If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become a fool, that he may be wise. For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God. For it is written, He taketh the wise in their own craftiness.

1 Corinthians 15:35-36 ¶ But some *man* will say, How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come? *Thou* fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die:

2 Corinthians 10:5 Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ;

1 Timothy 6:20 O Timothy, keep that which is committed to thy trust, avoiding profane *and* vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called:

2 Timothy 2:17 And their word will eat as doth a canker: of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus;

2 Timothy 2:18 Who concerning the truth have erred, saying that the resurrection is past already; and overthrow the faith of some.

2 Timothy 3:13 But evil men and seducers shall wax worse and worse, deceiving, and being deceived.

Not after the commandments and doctrines of men

Colossians 2:22 Which all are to perish with the using;) after the commandments and doctrines of men?

Matthew 15:2-9 Why do thy disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? for they wash not their hands when they eat bread. But he answered and said unto them, **Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition? For God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death. But ye say, Whosoever shall say to *his* father or *his* mother, *It is* a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me; And honour not his father or his mother, *he shall be free*. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition. Ye hypocrites, well did Esaias prophesy of you, saying, This people draweth nigh unto me with their mouth, and honoureth**

me with *their* lips; but their heart is far from me. But in vain they do worship me, teaching *for* doctrines the commandments of men.

Mark 7:3-13 For the Pharisees, and all the Jews, except they wash *their* hands oft, eat not, holding the tradition of the elders. And *when they come* from the market, except they wash, they eat not. And many other things there be, which they have received to hold, *as* the washing of cups, and pots, brassen vessels, and of tables. Then the Pharisees and scribes asked him, Why walk not thy disciples according to the tradition of the elders, but eat bread with unwashen hands? He answered and said unto them, *Well hath Esaias prophesied of you hypocrites, as it is written, This people honoureth me with their lips, but their heart is far from me. Howbeit in vain do they worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men. For laying aside the commandment of God, ye hold the tradition of men, as the washing of pots and cups: and many other such like things ye do.* And he said unto them, *Full well ye reject the commandment of God, that ye may keep your own tradition. For Moses said, Honour thy father and thy mother; and, Whoso curseth father or mother, let him die the death: But ye say, If a man shall say to his father or mother, It is Corban, that is to say, a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me; he shall be free. And ye suffer him no more to do ought for his father or his mother; Making the word of God of none effect through your tradition, which ye have delivered: and many such like things do ye.*

Galatians 1:14 And profited in the Jews' religion above many my equals in mine own nation, being more exceedingly zealous of the traditions of my fathers.